

At the beginning of the course, we've asked ourselves what is being, and what does human being mean. We asked this question explicitly, we've done this in the past perhaps, but perhaps we never asked ourselves this in a direct way.

Subsequently we tried to understand how networks and platforms change and alter our perception of identity and being part of a community.

Recently, we've shed a light on the origin and economics and cultural context where these relationships emerged, specifically in western capitalism (catholicism) vs anglosaxon capitalism (protestantism). From these two ways of understanding and interpreting way, where one is more oriented toward mediality (mediterranean), the other is centered on individualism.

Today, we see how techno-capitalism (fusion of technology, market and network) tends to remove differences between the two models, until it disappears.

We're proceeding in the observation of this phenomena, starting from the etymological level, that is words and "cum-capio", that means to take and gather together different elements, that leads to a concept ("cum-capio").

We thus took the concept and analyse the elements. We selected some keywords which are emblematic of the shift from the religious sphere to the economic sphere. These words, although they mean different things when used by companies, compared to original economic meaning, they still evoke the same emotions, and therefore triggers the same reactions (words are ... To be included).

Another word being instrumentalised is the one of community.

Today we must frame the relationship between community and capitalism through the Greek phenomena of consumption, which is one where the traces of the sacred in the economy is most evident. If we consider the geography of our landscape, the presence of hyper markets today occupy spaces that once were dedicated to churches. Beyond this external landscape, that (??) has been disfigured by the compulsion to monetise anything. Everything (including our identity) becomes something ready to be solved.

The accumulation of wealth of anglosaxons was always connected to the entrepreneurs work and commitment (??). Work was associated with the concept of vocation, "beruff", profession of faith, or profession understood as occupation. This was the instrument that proved being among the elected and deserving God's blessing.

In the 21st century it is no longer work that occupies the center of the economic system. We translate labor in "lavoro", "travailler" into "trabajar" and "travagliare". "labor" is the same word we use when we give birth (so, a lot of pain and effort). "travagliare" also means "to suffer", as they all come from "tripalium", which was a

kind of torture. Rather, entrepreneurs manager is the perfect consumer that is praised as he possesses the means to consume. The elect figure in the capitalism is now the one that can consume Gods, and no longer the one producing them through labor. The sacred figure of the entrepreneur as given way to a new prophet, the one that consumed without working, detaching wealth from production. An example is given by speculative finance. The blessing has shift from the production of good to consumption. This produces repercussion on labor. Work was the centrality of the economic system, but now it disappears behind the surface, and its place stands the cult of wealth obtained through financial speculation.

Working and producing are collective actions, they mean cooperation, require mutuality. IN the other hand, consumption can remain an individual action, and therefore it can be lived outside the community.

To understand how important was work, let's think of the first article of the Italian Constitution: "Italy is a Democratic Republic founded on labor".

Community means placing our talent, receiving gifts (??).

There is also another register, functioning by defining roles and hierarchies. Each person talent is made professional and remunerated. One level is on gratuity, the other is for money. They have to proceed together to get an equilibrium of the community.

Shifting from labor to consumption has lead to the communal relation ... has exited from the scene.

Markets traditionally are place of encounters where not only goods are exchange, but above all words, negotiations, judgement. The origin of the Greek language has taken place through a commercial exchange with Phoenicians, and so the words listed above are very close to Hermes. Beside being the messenger of Gods, he was also protector of travellers and merchants, that is those who move and travels in search for something, seeking to unite words (?) in order to take possession of them.

Today the market, that is emptied of people, remain nothing more than a giant digital showcase. The act of consumption is online purchasing where the product reaches our home without any other human being coming between ourselves and our desires. This is a state of progressive accommodation, in which capitalism invites us to eliminate effort.

"Desiderare" and "considerare". In the past, population had no clear line between astronomy and astrology, and by looking at the stars they would get what Gods wanted from them. To desider means something to get rid of, and not take into

account plans already given, and throw a project ourselves that may not be considering what is already given.

This is why the latest generation of gambling is the supreme icon of capitalism. For instance, horse betting. We went now, however, to individual objects and relationships where solitary people plays the machines, and buys "gratta e vinci". This form of gambling does not contain nothing relational, no rules shared with others. This type of activity is the narcissistic game. In the absence of others, the relationship is established exclusively with an object, and it intensifies until it becomes devouring. A gambler is consumed by the object itself, that is displayed as a totemic appearance. It has lights, colours, and endless hunger. The transition from labor to consumption is the result of a systematic operation of dismantling and de-valuing everything connected to effort.

Consumption is encouraged by capitalism, as everything is pleasure, with no pain and resistance. The new frontier of today's social struggle is shifting from "work for all", to "more consumption for all".

We cannot consider it properly as a religious phase, as it lacks spiritual boundaries, but it's neither atheist, as new Gods have replaced the old ones. It's a time of idolatry. Idolatries are economies of pure consumption. The totem object of idolatry does not work and the labor ...

The more idolatrous a culture is, the more it despises labour and worship consumption. The finance that promises a perpetual cult of consumption, is the idea of our age. Today, the privileged class is not so much the one that can economically afford certain goods, rather the one that also possess free time, necessary to enjoy them.

Labor is no longer how it was intended in the first article of our Constitution, so no longer intended as an instrument to affirm my dignity, rather it becomes an identifying activity. Consumption becomes a status for the upper class, in opposition to protestant ethic, strongly founded on labor. When we go from labor as a shared activity to an individual dimension... One of the main trend of the 20th century is to make individual consumption personalised, designed around the consumer's profile.

Just like figures of the manages, figures of the consumer ... is also manifesting a profound crisis.

The new frontier of the 21th capitalism is community. We're in a historical phase where capitalism consumes communities, breaking the communitarian bonds by folding everything back to the individual, and affirming the individual sovereignty, stripping away the dimension of gratuity, in order to return it in form of pain and goods.

An example: families. Family is a social complex based on mutuality and care. What happens when family becomes atomicon (bare minimum)? The care givers must be paid, and so they become care sellers instead of care givers. Capitalism has understood that it must reinvent itself by reorganising a form of consumption including a communitarian dimension, but without gratuity. As long as we've remained within an economy of scarcity of goods, the cult of the market needed only things to fill imagination and satisfy desires. When the majority of society surpassed the threshold of "sazietà", capitalism working began to consume communitarian relationships, as a community is necessary to spread the cult. Unlike other religions, that are integral and social phenomena, capitalism creates a formal religion among individuals who are separated from one another. Religion thus means to gather together people, but here we have a religion without bounds.

Nowadays, many markets communities across digital platforms raise the consumption ...

What we observe is that around certain products, with a strong market identity, communities of people gather, where the object becomes the founding element. They sacrifice time, energy and money for something that is not gratuitos at all. These products are not for free, they still have a price, and the profits do not go to worshippers, but to the owners of the brand, who are managers and not brand enthusiast, merely technicians.

We can observe this new form of religion, that is an idolatry, of pure worship that is filled with fetishes, a land emptied of Gods and of the sacred.

Our capitalims is becoming closer to the community also thanks to the propulsive effect of platforms, but is becoming so from a problematic perspective. Narrative marketing (market of the future, fully digital), recovers one typical element of traditional communities, to the point of constituting the primary capital, that is narrative capital. Our civilisation is made of given stories.

A faith is transmitted by telling stories.

The new digital marketing, in the era of post-scarcity of goods, where previously the merch was not that spread. We talk about "copia", which in latin has two meanings:

1. Great quantity
2. Repetitions, which is the foundation of the stereotype society.

Influences in this new digital marketing no longer present products expressing their technical characteristics like it used to be. They do not enchant us by describing the properties of objects, but rather they captivate us by telling stories.

"Incantare" is another word of this phenomena, cause in one hand it means to enchant, mesmerise, but on the other side something is "enchanted" when it's stuck (the disk is "incantato", stuck). There is a spell bound on us.

Trying to imitate the stories handled down to us by our families, those who tried to introduce us to sacred books, history of our nations, etc., are trying to build their narratives with this type of language, as its purpose is to activate consumers' emotions.

In order to sell us products, the new techno-capitalist enterprise must attempt to exploit our desires, resorting to the evocative power of need, reshaped to adapt to the purpose of the market.

Unlike this, the stories of faith, and those that we've inherited from our families were muted in gratuity, with the purpose of transmitting us a knowledge in the form of a present, and they made these stories light again uniquely for us. They did not want to sell us anything.

Differently, story telling constructed by multinational corporation seeks to activate our emotions to make us more vulnerable and more willing to buy something.

The motivation of market is small, as it lacks the gratuity that made the stories of communities and faith. The new enterprises tell us stories by placing them in the hands of the most followed influencers, who are nothing more than a plasticised version of myth.

These stories of yesterday knew how to charm us, as they did not want to chain us. With "fascinum", we have this ambiguous possibility to being something charming. Narration coming from the market has this second meaning.